



How to Protect Yourself & Others

Updated Jan. 30, 2021

Three Important Ways to Slow the Spread

- Wear a [mask](#) to protect yourself and others and stop the spread of COVID-19.
- [Stay at least 6 feet \(about 2 arm lengths\)](#) from others who don't live with you.
- Avoid crowds. The more people you are in contact with, the more likely you are to be exposed to COVID-19.

Cases in the last 7 days
1,045,440

Wear a mask

- Everyone 2 and older should wear masks in public.
- Masks should be worn in addition to staying at least 6 feet apart, especially around people who don't live with you.
- If someone in your household is infected, people in the household [should take precautions including wearing masks to avoid spread to others](#).
- [Wash your hands](#) or use hand sanitizer before putting on your mask.
- Wear your mask over your nose and mouth and secure it under your chin.
- Fit the mask snugly against the sides of your face, slipping the loops over your ears or tying the strings behind your head.
- If you have to continually adjust your mask, it doesn't fit properly, and you might need to find a different mask type or brand.
- Make sure you can breathe easily.

Effective February 2, 2021, [masks are required](#) on planes, buses, trains, and other forms of public transportation traveling into, within, or out of the United States and in U.S. transportation hubs such as airports and stations.

Stay 6 feet away from others

- **Inside your home:** Avoid close contact with people who are sick.
 - If possible, maintain 6 feet between the person who is sick and other household members.
- **Outside your home:** Put 6 feet of distance between yourself and people who don't live in your household.

Remember that some people without symptoms may be able to spread virus.

- [Stay at least 6 feet \(about 2 arm lengths\) from other people.](#)
- Keeping distance from others is especially important for [people who are at higher risk of getting very sick.](#)

Avoid crowds

- Being in crowds like in restaurants, bars, fitness centers, or movie theaters put you at higher risk for COVID-19.

Avoid poorly ventilated spaces

- Avoid indoor spaces that do not offer fresh air from the outdoors as much as possible. If indoors, bring in fresh air by opening windows and doors, if possible.

Wash your hands often

- [Wash your hands](#) often with soap and water for at least 20 seconds especially after you have been in a public place, or after blowing your nose, coughing, or sneezing.
- It's especially important to wash:
 - Before eating or preparing food
 - Before touching your face
 - After using the restroom
 - After leaving a public place
 - After blowing your nose, coughing, or sneezing
 - After handling your mask
 - After changing a diaper
 - After caring for someone sick
 - After touching animals or pets
- If soap and water are not readily available, **use a hand sanitizer that contains at least 60% alcohol**. Cover all surfaces of your hands and rub them together until they feel dry.
- **Avoid touching your eyes, nose, and mouth** with unwashed hands.

Cover coughs and sneezes

- **Always cover your mouth and nose** with a tissue when you cough or sneeze or use the inside of your elbow and do not spit.
- **Throw used tissues** in the trash.
- Immediately **wash your hands** with soap and water for at least 20 seconds. If soap and water are not readily available, clean your hands with a hand sanitizer that contains at least 60% alcohol.

Clean and disinfect

- **Clean AND disinfect [frequently touched surfaces](#) daily.** This includes tables, doorknobs, light switches, countertops, handles, desks, phones, keyboards, toilets, faucets, and sinks.
- **If surfaces are dirty, clean them.** Use detergent or soap and water prior to disinfection.
- **Then, use a household disinfectant.** Use products from [EPA's List N: Disinfectants for Coronavirus \(COVID-19\)](#) [↗](#) according to manufacturer's labeled directions.

Monitor Your Health Daily

- **Be alert for symptoms.** Watch for fever, cough, shortness of breath, or [other symptoms](#) of COVID-19.

- Especially important if you are [running essential errands](#), going into the office or workplace, and in settings where it may be difficult to keep a [physical distance of 6 feet](#).
- **Take your temperature** if symptoms develop.
 - Don't take your temperature within 30 minutes of exercising or after taking medications that could lower your temperature, like acetaminophen.
- Follow [CDC guidance](#) if symptoms develop.

Get Vaccinated to Protect Against COVID-19

- [COVID-19 vaccination](#) is especially important for people who may be more likely to get very sick from COVID-19, such as older adults and people with certain medical conditions.
- People with underlying medical conditions may get a COVID-19 vaccine as long as they have not had [a severe or immediate allergic reaction](#) to the first dose of a COVID-19 vaccine or any of the ingredients in a COVID-19 vaccine. CDC has made recommendations on [who should get vaccinated first](#).



Protect Your Health This Flu Season

It's likely that flu viruses and the virus that causes COVID-19 will **both** spread this fall and winter. Healthcare systems could be overwhelmed treating both patients with flu and patients with COVID-19. This means getting a flu vaccine during 2020-2021 is more important than ever.

While getting a flu vaccine will not protect against COVID-19 there are many important benefits, such as:

1. Flu vaccines have been shown to reduce the risk of flu illness, hospitalization, and death.
2. Getting a flu vaccine can also save healthcare resources for the care of patients with COVID-19.

I wear a mask because...

CDC staff give their reasons for wearing a mask.

Wear a mask because...



Handwashing Resources

More information

[Symptoms](#)

[What to do if you are sick](#)

[If someone in your house gets sick](#)

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Last Updated Jan. 30, 2021

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Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19)

How to Protect Yourself



Older adults and people who have severe underlying medical conditions like heart or lung disease or diabetes seem to be at higher risk for developing more serious complications from COVID-19 illness. More information on [Are you at higher risk for serious illness?](#)

Know How it Spreads



- There is currently no vaccine to prevent coronavirus disease 2019 (COVID-19).
- **The best way to prevent illness is to avoid being exposed to this virus.**
- The virus is thought to spread mainly from person-to-person.
 - Between people who are in close contact with one another (within about 6 feet).
 - Through respiratory droplets produced when an infected person coughs or sneezes.
- These droplets can land in the mouths or noses of people who are nearby or possibly be inhaled into the lungs.

Take steps to protect yourself



Clean your hands often

- **Wash your hands** often with soap and water for at least 20 seconds especially after you have been in a public place, or after blowing your nose, coughing, or sneezing.
- If soap and water are not readily available, **use a hand sanitizer that contains at least 60% alcohol**. Cover all surfaces of your hands and rub them together until they feel dry.
- **Avoid touching your eyes, nose, and mouth** with unwashed hands.



Avoid close contact

- **Avoid close contact** with people who are sick
- Put **distance between yourself and other people** if COVID-19 is spreading in your community. This is especially important for [people who are at higher risk of getting very sick](#).

Take steps to protect others



Stay home if you're sick

- **Stay home** if you are sick, except to get medical care. Learn [what to do if you are sick](#).



Cover coughs and sneezes

- **Cover your mouth and nose** with a tissue when you cough or sneeze or use the inside of your elbow.
- **Throw used tissues** in the trash.
- Immediately **wash your hands** with soap and water for at least 20 seconds. If soap and water are not readily available, clean your hands with a hand sanitizer that contains at least 60% alcohol.



Wear a facemask if you are sick

- **If you are sick:** You should wear a facemask when you are around other people (e.g., sharing a room or vehicle) and before you enter a healthcare provider's office. If you are not able to wear a facemask (for example, because it causes trouble breathing), then you should do your best to cover your coughs and sneezes, and people who are caring for you should wear a facemask if they enter your room. [Learn what to do if you are sick](#).
- **If you are NOT sick:** You do not need to wear a facemask unless you are caring for someone who is sick (and they are not able to wear a facemask). Facemasks may be in short supply and they should be saved for caregivers.



Clean and disinfect

- **Clean AND disinfect frequently touched surfaces daily.** This includes tables, doorknobs, light switches, countertops, handles, desks, phones, keyboards, toilets, faucets, and sinks.
- **If surfaces are dirty, clean them:** Use detergent or soap and water prior to disinfection.

To disinfect:

Most common EPA-registered household disinfectants will work. Use disinfectants appropriate for the surface.

Options include:

- **Diluting your household bleach.**
To make a bleach solution, mix:

- 5 tablespoons (1/3rd cup) bleach per gallon of water
OR
- 4 teaspoons bleach per quart of water

Follow manufacturer’s instructions for application and proper ventilation. Check to ensure the product is not past its expiration date. Never mix household bleach with ammonia or any other cleanser. Unexpired household bleach will be effective against coronaviruses when properly diluted.

- **Alcohol solutions.**
Ensure solution has at least 70% alcohol.
- **Other common EPA-registered household disinfectants.**
Products with [EPA-approved emerging viral pathogens](#)  [\[7 pages\]](#)  claims are expected to be effective against COVID-19 based on data for harder to kill viruses. Follow the manufacturer’s instructions for all cleaning and disinfection products (e.g., concentration, application method and contact time, etc.).

More handwashing tips

Hand Hygiene in Healthcare Settings

More information

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[6 Steps to Prevent COVID-19](#)

[6 Steps to Prevent COVID-19 \(ASL Version\)](#)

Page last reviewed: March 18, 2020



Coronavirus Disease 2019

How to Protect Yourself & Others

[Printer-friendly version](#)



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Know How it Spreads



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 - Through respiratory droplets produced when an infected person coughs, sneezes or talks.
 - These droplets can land in the mouths or noses of people who are nearby or possibly be inhaled into the lungs.
 - Some recent studies have suggested that COVID-19 may be spread by people who are not showing symptoms.

More details: [How COVID-19 Spreads](#)

Everyone Should



Clean your hands often

- [Wash your hands](#) often with soap and water for at least 20 seconds especially after you have been in a public place, or after blowing your nose, coughing, or sneezing.
- If soap and water are not readily available, **use a hand sanitizer that contains at least 60% alcohol**. Cover all surfaces of your hands and rub them together until they feel dry.
- **Avoid touching your eyes, nose, and mouth** with unwashed hands.



Avoid close contact

- Avoid close contact with people who are sick
- Stay home as much as possible.   | [Español  ]
- Put distance between yourself and other people.
 - Remember that some people without symptoms may be able to spread virus.
 - Keeping distance from others is especially important for [people who are at higher risk of getting very sick](#).



Cover your mouth and nose with a cloth face cover when around others

- You could spread COVID-19 to others even if you do not feel sick.
- Everyone should wear a cloth face cover when they have to go out in public, for example to the grocery store or to pick up other necessities.
 - Cloth face coverings should not be placed on young children under age 2, anyone who has trouble breathing, or is unconscious, incapacitated or otherwise unable to remove the mask without assistance.
- The cloth face cover is meant to protect other people in case you are infected.
- Do NOT use a facemask meant for a healthcare worker.
- Continue to keep about 6 feet between yourself and others. The cloth face cover is not a substitute for social distancing.

More details: [Cloth Face Covers](#)



Cover coughs and sneezes

- If you are in a private setting and do not have on your cloth face covering, remember to always cover your mouth and nose with a tissue when you cough or sneeze or use the inside of your elbow.
- Throw used tissues in the trash.
- Immediately **wash your hands** with soap and water for at least 20 seconds. If soap and water are not readily available, clean your hands with a hand sanitizer that contains at least 60% alcohol.



Clean and disinfect

- Clean AND disinfect [frequently touched surfaces](#) daily. This includes tables, doorknobs, light switches, countertops, handles, desks, phones, keyboards, toilets, faucets, and sinks.
- If surfaces are dirty, clean them. Use detergent or soap and water prior to disinfection.
- Then, use a household disinfectant. Most common [EPA-registered household disinfectant](#)  will work.

More details: [Cleaning And Disinfecting Your Home](#)

Related: [More handwashing tips](#)

Related: [Hand Hygiene in Healthcare Settings](#)

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Page last reviewed: April 13, 2020

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Coronavirus Disease 2019

How to Protect Yourself & Others

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Know how it spreads

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Everyone Should



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- If soap and water are not readily available, **use a hand sanitizer that contains at least 60% alcohol**. Cover all surfaces of your hands and rub them together until they feel dry.
- **Avoid touching your eyes, nose, and mouth** with unwashed hands.



Avoid close contact

- **Avoid close contact with people who are sick, even inside your home.** If possible, maintain 6 feet between the person who is sick and other household members.
- **Put distance between yourself and other people outside of your home.**
 - Remember that some people without symptoms may be able to spread virus.
 - [Stay at least 6 feet \(about 2 arms' length\) from other people.](#)
 - Do not gather in groups.
 - Stay out of crowded places and avoid mass gatherings.
 - Keeping distance from others is especially important for [people who are at higher risk of getting very sick.](#)



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- The cloth face cover is meant to protect other people in case you are infected.
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Handwashing Resources



[Handwashing tips](#)



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Coronavirus Disease 2019



How to Protect Yourself & Others

Updated Sept. 11, 2020

Older adults and people who have certain underlying conditions like heart or lung disease or diabetes are at increased risk of severe illness from COVID-19 illness. More information on [Are you at higher risk for serious illness.](#)

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- It's especially important to wash:
 - Before eating or preparing food
 - Before touching your face
 - After using the restroom
 - After leaving a public place
 - After blowing your nose, coughing, or sneezing
 - After handling your mask
 - After changing a diaper
 - After caring for someone sick
 - After touching animals or pets
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Avoid close contact

- **Inside your home:** Avoid close contact with people who are sick.
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Cover your mouth and nose with a mask when around others

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- Everyone should wear a [mask](#) in public settings and when around people who don't live in your household, especially when other [social distancing](#) measures are difficult to maintain.
 - Masks should not be placed on young children under age 2, anyone who has trouble breathing, or is unconscious, incapacitated or otherwise unable to remove the mask without assistance.
- Do NOT use a mask meant for a healthcare worker. Currently, surgical masks and N95 respirators are critical supplies that should be reserved for healthcare workers and other first responders.
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Cover coughs and sneezes

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Monitor Your Health Daily

- **Be alert for symptoms.** Watch for fever, cough, shortness of breath, or [other symptoms of COVID-19.](#)
 - Especially important if you are [running essential errands](#), going into the office or workplace, and in settings where it may be difficult to keep a [physical distance of 6 feet.](#)
- **Take your temperature** if symptoms develop.
 - Don't take your temperature within 30 minutes of exercising or after taking medications that could lower your temperature, like acetaminophen.
- Follow [CDC guidance](#) if symptoms develop.



Protect Your Health This Flu Season

It’s likely that flu viruses and the virus that causes COVID-19 will **both** spread this fall and winter. Healthcare systems could be overwhelmed treating both patients with flu and patients with COVID-19. This means getting a flu vaccine during 2020-2021 is more important than ever.

While getting a flu vaccine will not protect against COVID-19 there are many important benefits, such as:

- 1. Flu vaccines have been shown to reduce the risk of flu illness, hospitalization, and death.
- 2. Getting a flu vaccine can also save healthcare resources for the care of patients with COVID-19.

Stop the Spread of Germs

Robert R. Redfield, MD | #COVIDStopsWithMe

CDC Director Robert R. Redfield, MD discusses how we can slow the spread of COVID-19.

COVID–19 Stop the Spread of Germs

Help stop the spread of COVID-19 and other respiratory illnesses by following these steps.

Handwashing Resources

[View handwashing video in Spanish](#)

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Handwashing tips



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Coronavirus Disease 2019

 **Wear a mask.**

How to Protect Yourself & Others

Updated Nov. 4, 2020

Older adults and people who have certain underlying conditions like heart or lung disease or diabetes are at increased risk of severe illness from COVID-19 illness. More information on [Are you at higher risk for serious illness](#).

Know how it spreads

- COVID-19 spreads easily from person to person, mainly by the following routes:
 - Between people who are in close contact with one another (within 6 feet).
 - Through respiratory droplets produced when an infected person coughs, sneezes, breathes, sings or talks.
 - Respiratory droplets cause infection when they are inhaled or deposited on mucous membranes, such as those that line the inside of the nose and mouth.
- People who are infected but do not have symptoms can also spread the virus to others.

Less common ways COVID-19 can spread

- Under certain circumstances (for example, when people are in enclosed spaces with poor ventilation), COVID-19 can sometimes be spread by [airborne transmission](#).
- COVID-19 spreads less commonly through contact with contaminated surfaces.

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COVID-19

 Cases are rising. Act now! Wear a mask; Stay 6 feet apart; Avoid crowds.

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Know how it spreads

- COVID-19 spreads easily from person to person, mainly by the following routes:
 - Between people who are in close contact with one another (within 6 feet).
 - Through respiratory droplets produced when an infected person coughs, sneezes, breathes, sings or talks.
 - Respiratory droplets cause infection when they are inhaled or deposited on mucous membranes, such as those that line the inside of the nose and mouth.
- People who are infected but do not have symptoms can also spread the virus to others.

Less common ways COVID-19 can spread

- Under certain circumstances (for example, when people are in enclosed spaces with poor ventilation), COVID-19 can sometimes be spread by [airborne transmission](#).
- COVID-19 spreads less commonly through contact with contaminated surfaces.

Everyone Should

Wash your hands often

- [Wash your hands](#) often with soap and water for at least 20 seconds especially after you have been in a public place, or after blowing your nose, coughing, or sneezing.
- It's especially important to wash:
 - Before eating or preparing food
 - Before touching your face
 - After using the restroom
 - After leaving a public place
 - After blowing your nose, coughing, or sneezing
 - After handling your mask
 - After changing a diaper
 - After caring for someone sick
 - After touching animals or pets

- If soap and water are not readily available, **use a hand sanitizer that contains at least 60% alcohol**. Cover all surfaces of your hands and rub them together until they feel dry.
- **Avoid touching your eyes, nose, and mouth** with unwashed hands.

Avoid close contact

- **Inside your home:** Avoid close contact with people who are sick.
 - If possible, maintain 6 feet between the person who is sick and other household members.
- **Outside your home:** Put 6 feet of distance between yourself and people who don't live in your household.
 - Remember that some people without symptoms may be able to spread virus.
 - [Stay at least 6 feet \(about 2 arms' length\) from other people.](#)
 - Keeping distance from others is especially important for [people who are at higher risk of getting very sick.](#)

Cover your mouth and nose with a mask when around others

- Masks help prevent you from getting or spreading the virus.
- You could spread COVID-19 to others even if you do not feel sick.
- Everyone should wear a [mask](#) in public settings and when around people who don't live in your household, especially when other [social distancing](#) measures are difficult to maintain.
 - Masks should not be placed on young children under age 2, anyone who has trouble breathing, or is unconscious, incapacitated or otherwise unable to remove the mask without assistance.
- Do NOT use a mask meant for a healthcare worker. Currently, surgical masks and N95 respirators are critical supplies that should be reserved for healthcare workers and other first responders.
- Continue to keep about 6 feet between yourself and others. The mask is not a substitute for social distancing.

Cover coughs and sneezes

- **Always cover your mouth and nose** with a tissue when you cough or sneeze or use the inside of your elbow and do not spit.
- **Throw used tissues** in the trash.
- Immediately **wash your hands** with soap and water for at least 20 seconds. If soap and water are not readily available, clean your hands with a hand sanitizer that contains at least 60% alcohol.

Clean and disinfect

- **Clean AND disinfect [frequently touched surfaces](#) daily.** This includes tables, doorknobs, light switches, countertops, handles, desks, phones, keyboards, toilets, faucets, and sinks.
- **If surfaces are dirty, clean them.** Use detergent or soap and water prior to disinfection.
- **Then, use a household disinfectant.** Most common [EPA-registered household disinfectants](#) [↗](#) will work.

Monitor Your Health Daily

- **Be alert for symptoms.** Watch for fever, cough, shortness of breath, or [other symptoms of COVID-19](#).
 - Especially important if you are [running essential errands](#), going into the office or workplace, and in settings where it may be difficult to keep a [physical distance of 6 feet](#).

- **Take your temperature** if symptoms develop.
 - Don't take your temperature within 30 minutes of exercising or after taking medications that could lower your temperature, like acetaminophen.
- Follow [CDC guidance](#) if symptoms develop.



Protect Your Health This Flu Season

It's likely that flu viruses and the virus that causes COVID-19 will **both** spread this fall and winter. Healthcare systems could be overwhelmed treating both patients with flu and patients with COVID-19. This means getting a flu vaccine during 2020-2021 is more important than ever.

While getting a flu vaccine will not protect against COVID-19 there are many important benefits, such as:

1. Flu vaccines have been shown to reduce the risk of flu illness, hospitalization, and death.
2. Getting a flu vaccine can also save healthcare resources for the care of patients with COVID-19.

I wear a mask because...

CDC staff give their reasons for wearing a mask.

Wear a mask because...

Stop the Spread of Germs

Robert R. Redfield, MD | #COVIDStopsWithMe

CDC Director Robert R. Redfield, MD discusses how we can slow the spread of COVID-19.

COVID-19 Stop the Spread of Germs

Help stop the spread of COVID-19 and other respiratory illnesses by following these steps.

Handwashing Resources

[View handwashing video in Spanish](#)

[View handwashing video in French](#)



[Handwashing tips](#)



[Hand Hygiene in Healthcare Settings](#)

More information

[Symptoms](#)

[What to do if you are sick](#)

[If someone in your house gets sick](#)

[Frequently asked questions](#)

[Travelers](#)

[Individuals, schools, events, businesses and more](#)

[Healthcare Professionals](#)

[10 Things You Can Do to Manage COVID-19 at Home](#)

[10 Things You Can Do to Manage COVID-19 at Home \(ASL Version\)](#)

[Social Distancing \(ASL Video\)](#)

[ASL Video Series: What You Need to Know About Handwashing](#)

Last Updated Nov. 27, 2020



COVID-19

CASES ARE RISING.
ACT NOW!


WEAR A MASK


STAY 6 FEET APART


AVOID CROWDS

How to Protect Yourself & Others

Updated Dec. 31, 2020

Older adults and people who have certain underlying conditions like heart or lung disease or diabetes are at increased risk of severe illness from COVID-19 illness. More information on [Are you at higher risk for serious illness.](#)

Three Important Ways to Slow the Spread

- Wear a [mask](#) to protect yourself and others and stop the spread of COVID-19.
- [Stay at least 6 feet \(about 2 arm lengths\)](#) from others who don't live with you.
- Avoid crowds. The more people you are in contact with, the more likely you are to be exposed to COVID-19.

Cases in the last 7 days

1,551,850

Wear a mask over your nose and mouth

- Masks help prevent you from getting or spreading the virus.
- You could spread COVID-19 to others even if you do not feel sick.
- Everyone should wear a [mask](#) in public settings and when around people who don't live in your household, especially when other [social distancing](#) measures are difficult to maintain.
 - Masks should not be placed on young children under age 2, anyone who has trouble breathing, or is unconscious, incapacitated or otherwise unable to remove the mask without assistance.
- Do NOT use a mask meant for a healthcare worker. Currently, surgical masks and N95 respirators are critical supplies that should be reserved for healthcare workers and other first responders.
- Continue to keep about 6 feet between yourself and others. The mask is not a substitute for social distancing.

Stay 6 feet away from others

- **Inside your home:** Avoid close contact with people who are sick.
 - If possible, maintain 6 feet between the person who is sick and other household members.
- **Outside your home:** Put 6 feet of distance between yourself and people who don't live in your household.
 - Remember that some people without symptoms may be able to spread virus.

- [Stay at least 6 feet \(about 2 arms' length\) from other people.](#)
- Keeping distance from others is especially important for [people who are at higher risk of getting very sick.](#)

Avoid crowds

- Being in crowds like in restaurants, bars, fitness centers, or movie theaters put you at higher risk for COVID-19.

Avoid poorly ventilated spaces

- Avoid indoor spaces that do not offer fresh air from the outdoors as much as possible. If indoors, bring in fresh air by opening windows and doors, if possible.

Wash your hands often

- [Wash your hands](#) often with soap and water for at least 20 seconds especially after you have been in a public place, or after blowing your nose, coughing, or sneezing.
- It's especially important to wash:
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 - After blowing your nose, coughing, or sneezing
 - After handling your mask
 - After changing a diaper
 - After caring for someone sick
 - After touching animals or pets
- If soap and water are not readily available, **use a hand sanitizer that contains at least 60% alcohol**. Cover all surfaces of your hands and rub them together until they feel dry.
- **Avoid touching your eyes, nose, and mouth** with unwashed hands.

Cover coughs and sneezes

- **Always cover your mouth and nose** with a tissue when you cough or sneeze or use the inside of your elbow and do not spit.
- **Throw used tissues** in the trash.
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Clean and disinfect

- **Clean AND disinfect [frequently touched surfaces](#) daily.** This includes tables, doorknobs, light switches, countertops, handles, desks, phones, keyboards, toilets, faucets, and sinks.
- **If surfaces are dirty, clean them.** Use detergent or soap and water prior to disinfection.
- **Then, use a household disinfectant.** Use products from [EPA's List N: Disinfectants for Coronavirus \(COVID-19\)](#) [↗](#) according to manufacturer's labeled directions.

Monitor Your Health Daily

- **Be alert for symptoms.** Watch for fever, cough, shortness of breath, or [other symptoms of COVID-19](#).
 - Especially important if you are [running essential errands](#), going into the office or workplace, and in settings where it may be difficult to keep a [physical distance of 6 feet](#).

- **Take your temperature** if symptoms develop.
 - Don't take your temperature within 30 minutes of exercising or after taking medications that could lower your temperature, like acetaminophen.
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Protect Your Health This Flu Season

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I wear a mask because...

CDC staff give their reasons for wearing a mask.

Wear a mask because...



Handwashing Resources

More information

[Symptoms](#)

What to do if you are sick

If someone in your house gets sick

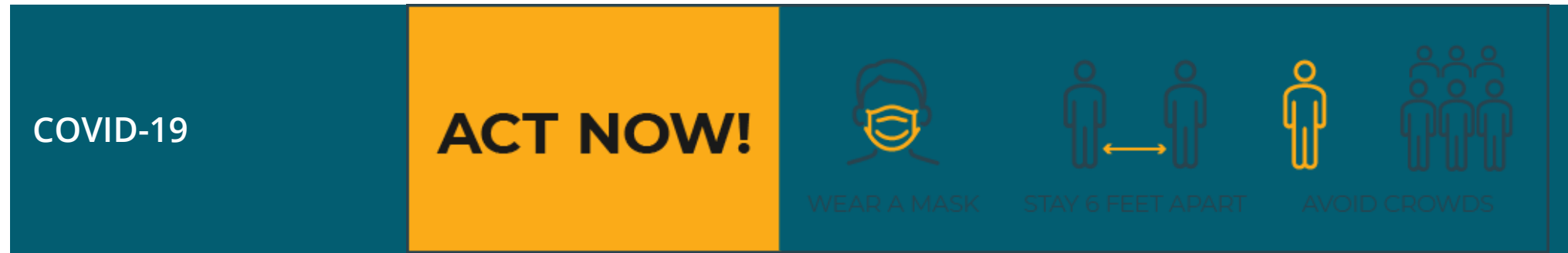
Frequently asked questions

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Individuals, schools, events, businesses and more

Healthcare Professionals

Last Updated Dec. 31, 2020



Updated Jan. 30, 2021

Languages ▾

Three Important Ways to Slow the Spread

- Wear a [mask](#) to protect yourself and others and stop the spread of COVID-19.
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- Avoid crowds. The more people you are in contact with, the more likely you are to be exposed to COVID-19.

Cases in the last 7 days

Update:

[Find cases in your community.](#)

Wear a mask

- Everyone 2 and older should wear masks in public.
- Masks should be worn in addition to staying at least 6 feet apart, especially around people who don't live with you.
- If someone in your household is infected, people in the household [should take precautions including wearing masks to avoid spread to others](#).
- [Wash your hands](#) or use hand sanitizer before putting on your mask.
- Wear your mask over your nose and mouth and secure it under your chin.
- Fit the mask snugly against the sides of your face, slipping the loops over your ears or tying the strings behind your head.
- If you have to continually adjust your mask, it doesn't fit properly, and you might need to find a different mask type or brand.
- Make sure you can breathe easily.

Effective February 2, 2021, [masks are required](#) on planes, buses, trains, and other forms of public transportation traveling into, within, or out of the United States and in U.S. transportation hubs such as airports and stations.

Stay 6 feet away from others

- **Inside your home:** Avoid close contact with people who are sick.
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Avoid crowds

- Being in crowds like in restaurants, bars, fitness centers, or movie theaters put you at higher risk for COVID-19.

Avoid poorly ventilated spaces

- Avoid indoor spaces that do not offer fresh air from the outdoors as much as possible. If indoors, bring in fresh air by opening windows and doors, if possible.

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 - After caring for someone sick
 - After touching animals or pets
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Cover coughs and sneezes

- **Always cover your mouth and nose** with a tissue when you cough or sneeze or use the inside of your elbow and do not spit.
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Monitor Your Health Daily

- **Be alert for symptoms.** Watch for fever, cough, shortness of breath, or [other symptoms](#) of COVID-19.

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Get Vaccinated to Protect Against COVID-19

- [COVID-19 vaccination](#) is especially important for people who may be more likely to get very sick from COVID-19, such as older adults and people with certain medical conditions.
- People with underlying medical conditions may get a COVID-19 vaccine as long as they have not had [a severe or immediate allergic reaction](#) to the first dose of a COVID-19 vaccine or any of the ingredients in a COVID-19 vaccine. CDC has made recommendations on [who should get vaccinated first](#).



Protect Your Health This Flu Season

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I wear a mask because...

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Handwashing Resources

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[What to do if you are sick](#)

[If someone in your house gets sick](#)

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[Travelers](#)

[Individuals, schools, events, businesses and more](#)

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View Page In:  269 KB, 2 pages



Last Updated Jan. 30, 2021

 Your Health

Things You Need to Know

Symptoms +

Testing +

How it Spreads +

Prevent Getting Sick +

If You Are Sick +

People at Increased Risk +

Daily Activities & Going Out +

Travel +

Children & Teens +

Stress & Coping +

Pets & Other Animals +

Frequently Asked Questions

 Get Email Updates

To receive email updates about COVID-19, enter your email address:

Email Address

[What's this?](#)

Submit

LANGUAGE ASSISTANCE

[Español](#)

[Tagalog](#)

 [體中文](#)

 [Р?кй](#)

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Kreyòl Ayisyen

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Deutsch

Polski

日本語

Português

ارسی؟

Italiano

English

CONTACT CDC



ABOUT CDC



POLICIES



LANGUAGES



U.S. Department of Health & Human Services

USA.gov

The Wayback Machine - <https://web.archive.org/web/20210211014308/https://www.cdc.gov/coronavirus/2019-ncov/prevent-get...>



Centers for Disease
Control and Prevention



COVID-19

ACT NOW!



WEAR A MASK



STAY 6 FEET APART



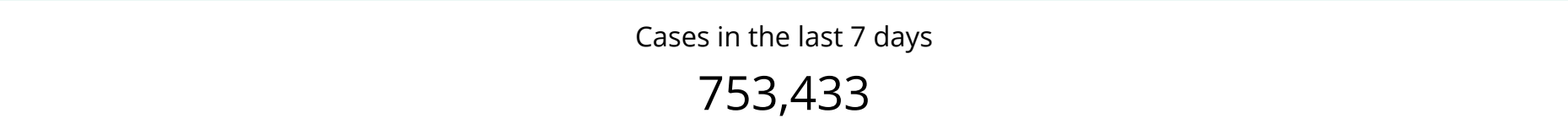
AVOID CROWDS

How to Protect Yourself & Others

Updated Feb. 4, 2021

Three Important Ways to Slow the Spread

- Wear a [mask](#) to protect yourself and others and stop the spread of COVID-19.
- [Stay at least 6 feet \(about 2 arm lengths\)](#) from others who don't live with you.
- Avoid crowds. The more people you are in contact with, the more likely you are to be exposed to COVID-19.



Wear a mask

- Everyone 2 and older should wear masks in public.
- Masks should be worn in addition to staying at least 6 feet apart, especially around people who don't live with you.
- If someone in your household is infected, people in the household [should take precautions including wearing masks to avoid spread to others](#).
- [Wash your hands](#) or use hand sanitizer before putting on your mask.
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Avoid crowds

- Being in crowds like in restaurants, bars, fitness centers, or movie theaters put you at higher risk for COVID-19.

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- Avoid indoor spaces that do not offer fresh air from the outdoors as much as possible. If indoors, bring in fresh air by opening windows and doors, if possible.

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Cover coughs and sneezes

- **Always cover your mouth and nose** with a tissue when you cough or sneeze or use the inside of your elbow and do not spit.
- **Throw used tissues** in the trash.
- Immediately **wash your hands** with soap and water for at least 20 seconds. If soap and water are not readily available, clean your hands with a hand sanitizer that contains at least 60% alcohol.

Clean and disinfect

- **Clean AND disinfect [frequently touched surfaces](#) daily.** This includes tables, doorknobs, light switches, countertops, handles, desks, phones, keyboards, toilets, faucets, and sinks.
- **If surfaces are dirty, clean them.** Use detergent or soap and water prior to disinfection.
- **Then, use a household disinfectant.** Use products from [EPA's List N: Disinfectants for Coronavirus \(COVID-19\)](#) [↗](#) according to manufacturer's labeled directions.

Monitor Your Health Daily

- **Be alert for symptoms.** Watch for fever, cough, shortness of breath, or [other symptoms](#) of COVID-19.

- Especially important if you are [running essential errands](#), going into the office or workplace, and in settings where it may be difficult to keep a [physical distance of 6 feet](#).
- **Take your temperature** if symptoms develop.
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CDC staff give their reasons for wearing a mask.

Wear a mask because...



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Last Updated Feb. 4, 2021

The Wayback Machine - <https://web.archive.org/web/20220331235610/https://www.cdc.gov/coronavirus/2019-ncov/prevent-get...>



COVID-19

How to Protect Yourself & Others

Updated Feb. 25, 2022

Get Vaccinated and stay up to date on your COVID-19 vaccines

- [COVID-19 vaccines](#) are effective at preventing you from getting sick. COVID-19 vaccines are highly effective at preventing severe illness, hospitalizations, and death.
- Getting vaccinated is the best way to slow the spread of SARS-CoV-2, the virus that causes COVID-19.
- CDC recommends that everyone who is eligible [stay up to date on their COVID-19 vaccines](#), including [people with weakened immune systems](#).

Wear a mask

- Everyone ages 2 years and older should properly wear a well-fitting mask indoors in public in areas where the [COVID-19 Community Level](#) is high, regardless of vaccination status.
- Wear a mask with the best fit, protection, and comfort for you.
- If you are in an area with a high [COVID-19 Community Level](#) and are ages 2 or older, wear a mask indoors in public.
- If you are sick and need to be around others, or are caring for someone who has COVID-19, wear a mask.
- If you are at increased risk for severe illness, or live with or spend time with someone at higher risk, speak to your healthcare provider about wearing a mask at medium COVID-19 Community Levels.
- People who have a condition or are taking medications that [weaken their immune system](#) may not be fully protected even if they are up to date on their COVID-19 vaccines. They should talk to their healthcare providers about what additional precautions may be necessary.
 - For more information, see [COVID-19 Vaccines for Moderately or Severely Immunocompromised People](#)

[Wearing a mask over your nose and mouth is required](#) on planes, buses, trains, and other forms of public transportation traveling into, within, or out of the United States and while indoors at U.S. transportation hubs such as airports and stations. Travelers are not required to wear a mask in outdoor areas of a conveyance (like on open deck areas of a ferry or the uncovered top deck of a bus).

Stay 6 feet away from others

- Inside your home: Avoid close contact with people who are sick, if possible. If possible, maintain 6 feet between the person who is sick and other household members. If you are taking care of someone who is sick, make sure you properly wear a [well-fitting mask](#) and follow other steps to protect yourself.
- Indoors in public: If you are not [up to date on COVID-19 vaccines](#), stay at least 6 feet away from other people, especially if you are at [higher risk of getting very sick](#) with COVID-19.

Avoid poorly ventilated spaces and crowds

- If indoors, [bring in fresh air](#) by opening windows and doors, if possible.
- If you are at [increased risk of getting very sick](#) from COVID-19, avoid crowded places and indoor spaces that do not have fresh air from the outdoors.

Test to prevent spread to others

- You can choose from many different [types of tests](#).
- Tests for [SARS-CoV-2](#) (the virus that causes COVID-19) tell you [if you have an infection](#) at the time of the test. This type of test is called a **viral test** because it looks for viral infection.
- Regardless of the test type you select, a [positive test result](#) means that you have an infection and should [isolate](#) and inform your [close contacts](#) to avoid spreading disease to others.
- Over-the-counter [self-tests](#) are viral tests that can be used at home or anywhere, are easy to use, and produce rapid results. Anyone can use self-tests, regardless of their vaccination status or whether they have symptoms.
- COVID-19 [self-tests](#) are one of many risk-reduction measures, along with vaccination, masking, and physical distancing, that protect you and others by reducing the chances of spreading COVID-19.

Wash your hands often

- [Wash your hands](#) often with soap and water for at least 20 seconds especially after you have been in a public place, or after blowing your nose, coughing, or sneezing.
- It's especially important to wash your hands:
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 - After caring for someone sick
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- If soap and water are not readily available, **use a hand sanitizer that contains at least 60% alcohol**. Cover all surfaces of your hands and rub them together until they feel dry.
- **Avoid touching your eyes, nose, and mouth** with unwashed hands.

Cover coughs and sneezes

- **If you are wearing a mask:** You can cough or sneeze into your mask. Put on a new, clean mask as soon as possible and wash your hands.
- **If you are not wearing a mask:**
 - Always cover your mouth and nose with a tissue when you cough or sneeze, or use the inside of your elbow and do not spit.
 - Throw used tissues in the trash.
 - Immediately **wash your hands** with soap and water for at least 20 seconds. If soap and water are not readily available, clean your hands with a hand sanitizer that contains at least 60% alcohol.

Clean and disinfect

- Clean high touch surfaces regularly or as needed and after you have visitors in your home. This includes tables, doorknobs, light switches, countertops, handles, desks, phones, keyboards, toilets, faucets, and sinks.
- If someone is sick or has tested positive for COVID-19, disinfect [frequently touched surfaces](#).
 - Use a household disinfectant product from [EPA's List N: Disinfectants for Coronavirus \(COVID-19\)](#) [↗](#) according to manufacturer's labeled directions.
 - If surfaces are dirty, clean them using detergent or soap and water prior to disinfection.

Monitor your health daily

- Be alert for symptoms:
 - Watch for fever, cough, shortness of breath, or [other symptoms](#) of COVID-19.
 - Take your temperature if symptoms develop.
 - Don't take your temperature within 30 minutes of exercising or after taking medications that could lower your temperature, like acetaminophen.
 - Follow [CDC guidance](#) if symptoms develop.
- Monitoring symptoms is especially important if you are running errands, going into the office or workplace, and in settings where it may be difficult to keep a physical distance of 6 feet.

Follow recommendations for quarantine

- If you come into [close contact](#) with someone with COVID-19: follow CDC's [recommendations for quarantine](#).

Follow recommendations for isolation

- If you [test positive](#) for COVID-19 or have [symptoms](#): follow CDC's [recommendations for isolation](#).

Take precautions when you travel

- Follow CDC's [recommendations for domestic and international travel](#).

Additional Resources

For more information, see:

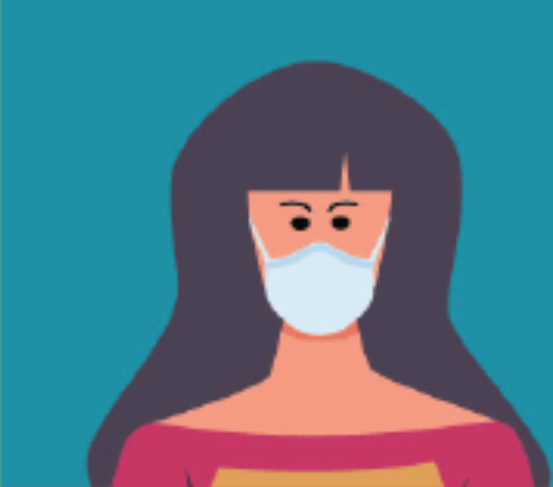
- [Families with vaccinated and unvaccinated members](#)
- [Improve How Your Mask Protects You](#)
- Information for specific groups of people (link: [COVID-19 Information for Specific Groups of People | CDC](#))

Help protect yourself and others

Help Protect Yourself and Others |COVID-19|

Stay up to date on COVID-19 vaccinations





Wear a mask indoors
When COVID-19 Community Level is high

Avoid crowds and poorly ventilated spaces



Test to prevent spread to others



Wash your hands often





[cdc.gov/coronavirus](https://www.cdc.gov/coronavirus)

CS327146B | 05/01/2022

 [PDF - 681 KB, 1 page]

Related Pages

- > [Prevent Getting Sick](#)
- > [Symptoms](#)

- › [How COVID-19 Spreads](#)
- › [If You Are Sick or Caring for Someone](#)
- › [People at Increased Risk](#)
- › [Frequently Asked Questions](#)
- › [Hand Sanitizer Use](#)
- › [Quarantine and Isolation](#)

Last Updated Feb. 25, 2022



COVID-19



MENU >

Updated Aug. 11, 2022 [Español](#) | [Other Languages](#)

COVID-19 Prevention Actions

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In addition to basic health and hygiene practices, like [handwashing](#), CDC recommends some prevention actions at all COVID-19 Community Levels, which include:

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***If you are moderately or severely immunocompromised or severely allergic to COVID-19 vaccines:** Talk with a healthcare provider about whether you are eligible for a medicine called Evusheld that you can take before you are exposed to the virus. This medicine is a combination of two monoclonal antibodies provided together. Evusheld can help prevent infection from the virus that causes COVID-19 for 6 months. See [additional information](#) for making a COVID-19 plan to protect yourself from infection.*

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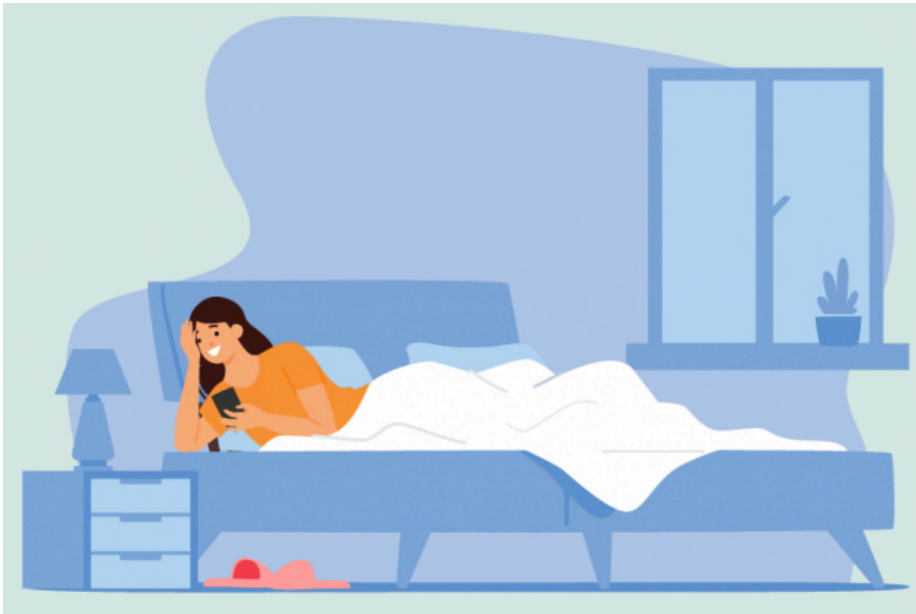
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There are some additional prevention actions that may be done at any level, but CDC especially recommends considering in certain circumstances or at medium or high [COVID-19 Community Levels](#).

- [Wearing Masks or Respirators](#)

- [Increasing Space and Distance](#)

Wearing Masks or Respirators

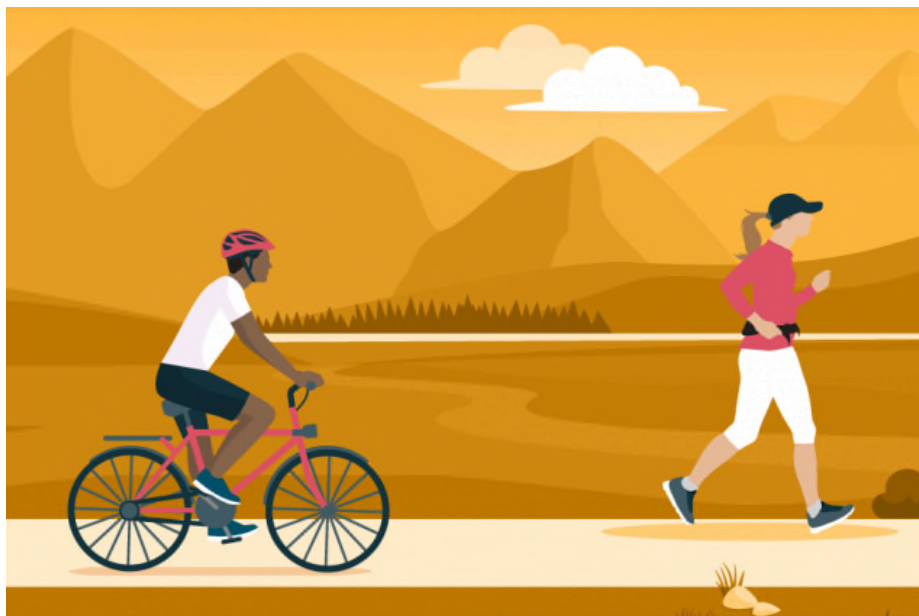


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Last Updated Aug. 11, 2022



Your Health

About COVID-19



Symptoms



Testing



Understanding Your Risk



COVID-19 by County

Protect Yourself & Others



Vaccines

Masks



Ventilation



If You Were Exposed

If You Are Sick



Long COVID



Travel



Get Email Updates

To receive email updates about COVID-19, enter your email address:

[What's this?](#)

Submit

CONTACT CDC



ABOUT CDC



POLICIES



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LANGUAGES



COVID-19 Web Archive

U.S. Department of Health & Human Services

USA.gov



How to Protect Yourself and Others

Updated Oct. 19, 2022

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 PDF thumbnail of Your COVID-19 Plan

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File Details: 561 KB, 3 pages

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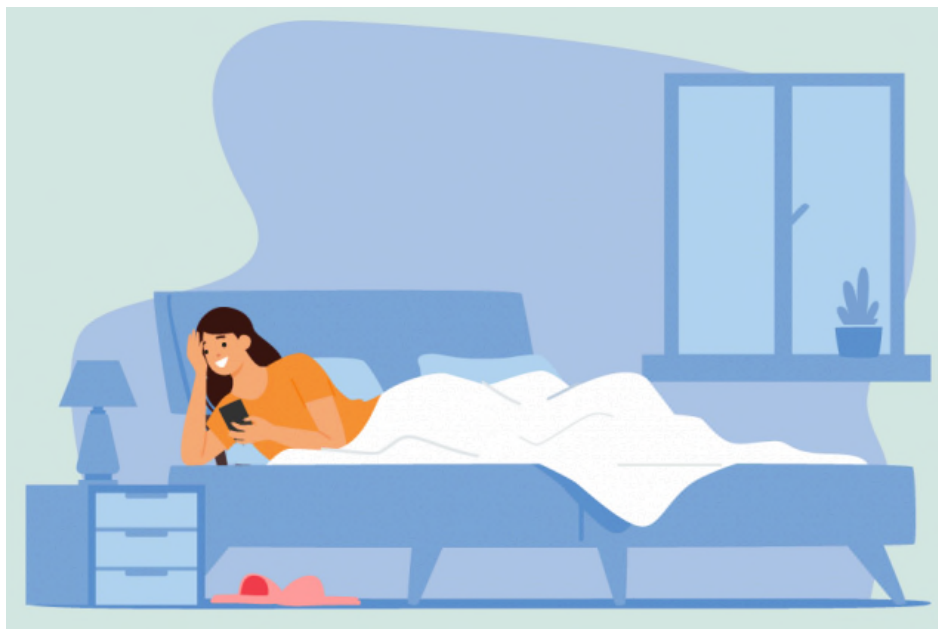
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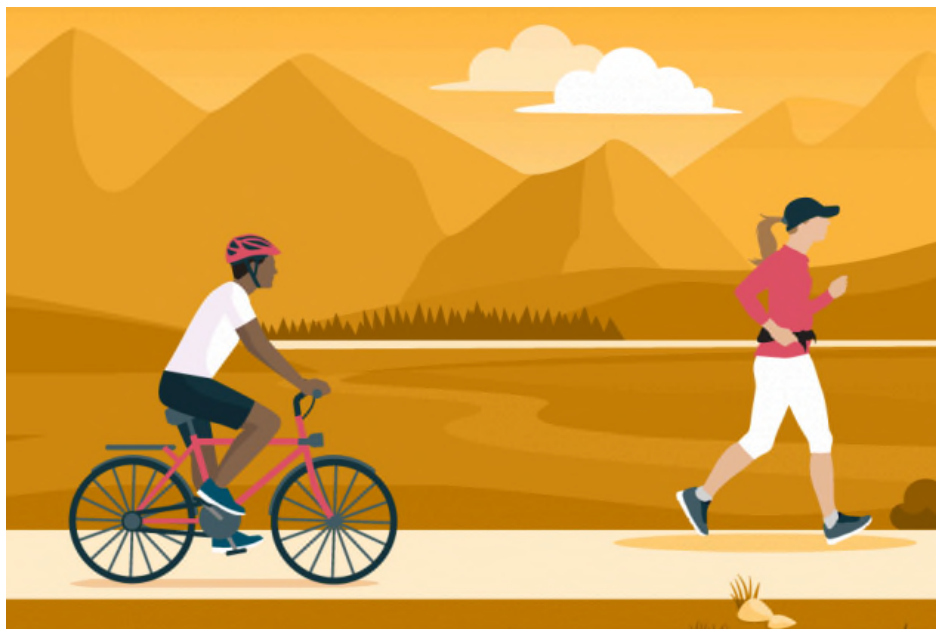


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Last Updated Oct. 19, 2022



How to Protect Yourself and Others

Updated Jan. 26, 2023

As of January 26, 2023, EVUSHELD™ is not currently authorized for emergency use because it is unlikely to be active against the majority of SARS-CoV-2 variants circulating in the United States.

COVID-19 Prevention Actions

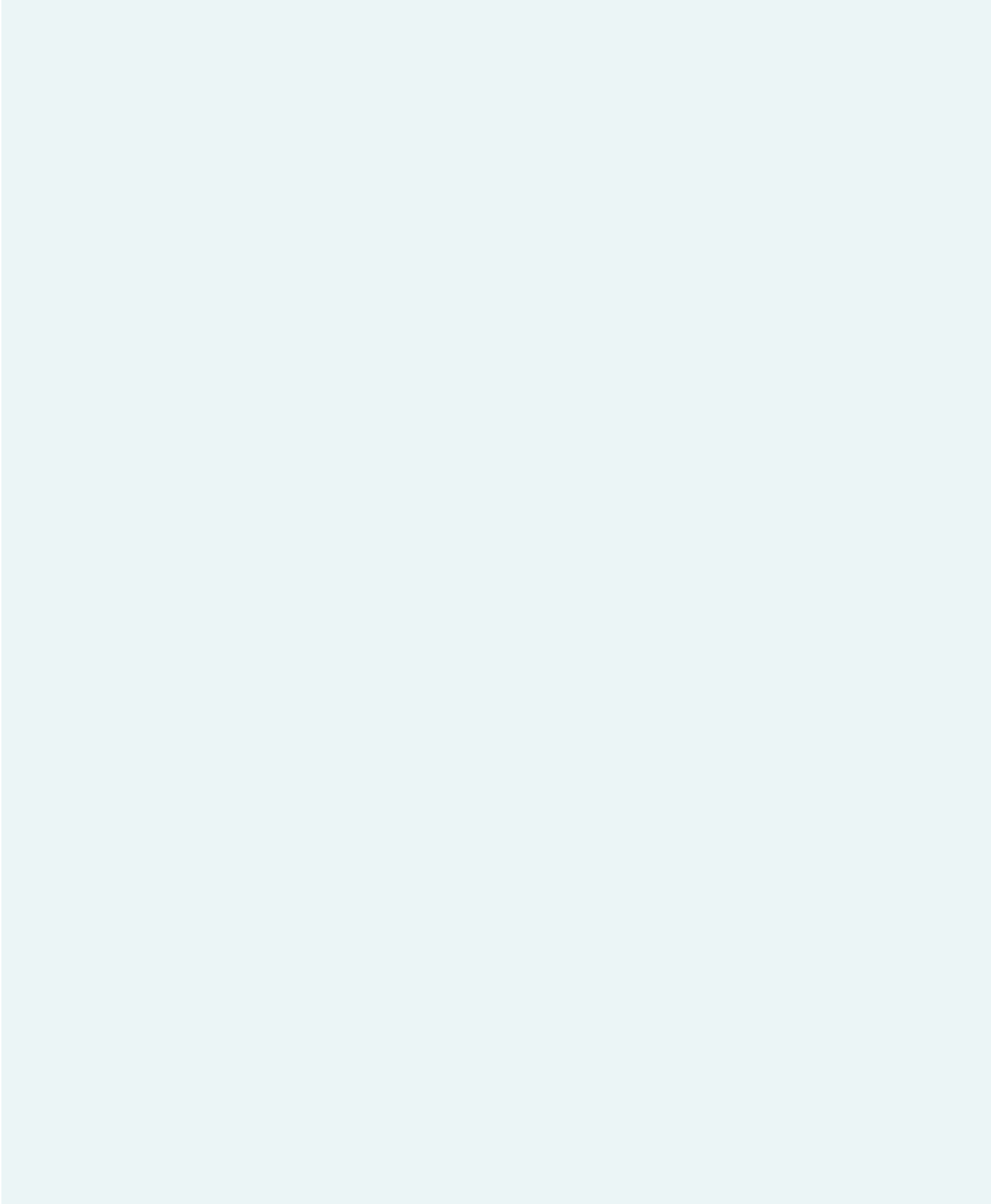
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Build Your Personal COVID-19 Plan



COVID-19 Plan

Tools, information, and action steps to share with your family, friends, and healthcare provider

Start your personal COVID-19 plan

Talk with your healthcare provider about whether you are at high risk of getting very sick from COVID-19 .

- People who are more likely to get very sick include older adults (ages 50 years or more, with risk increasing with age), people who are unvaccinated, and people with certain medical conditions, such as chronic lung disease, heart disease, or a weakened immune system.

Understanding risk

<https://www.cdc.gov/coronavirus/2019-ncov/your-health/understanding-risk.html>

- People with risk factors for severe disease may benefit from treatment if they get COVID-19. A healthcare provider will help decide which treatment, if any, is right for you.

Tests

Have a supply of COVID-19 self-test kits at home and know when and how to use them.

<https://www.cdc.gov/coronavirus/2019-ncov/testing/self-testing.html>

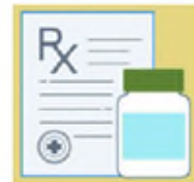
- If you have symptoms of COVID-19, test immediately.
- If you test positive, treatments are available that can reduce your chances of hospitalization and death.



Treatment

Have a plan to contact a healthcare provider right away if you test positive.

- Don't delay: Treatment must be started within days after you first develop symptoms to be effective.



Healthcare provider

If you don't have a healthcare provider, consider telehealth options or contact a Test to Treat site to get tested, evaluated, and treated in one location.

- Test to Treat locations: <https://covid-19-test-to-treat-locator-dhhs.hub.arcgis.com/>

Take precautions

COVID-19 in your Community: Keep track of your COVID-19 Community Level and use it to guide your precautions: <https://www.cdc.gov/coronavirus/2019-ncov/your-health/covid-by-county.html>

Vaccines

Stay up to date on vaccines. Know when to get a booster:

<https://www.cdc.gov/coronavirus/2019-ncov/vaccines/stay-up-to-date.html>

Ventilation

Spend time outside and improve indoor air quality at home by opening windows and using adequate filtration.



Masks

Masks are recommended for those at high risk when COVID-19 community levels are medium and for everyone when levels are high. Learn more:

<https://www.cdc.gov/coronavirus/2019-ncov/prevent-getting-sick/about-face-coverings.html>



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File Details: 561 KB, 3 pages

[View PDF in English](#) 

[View PDF in Spanish](#) 

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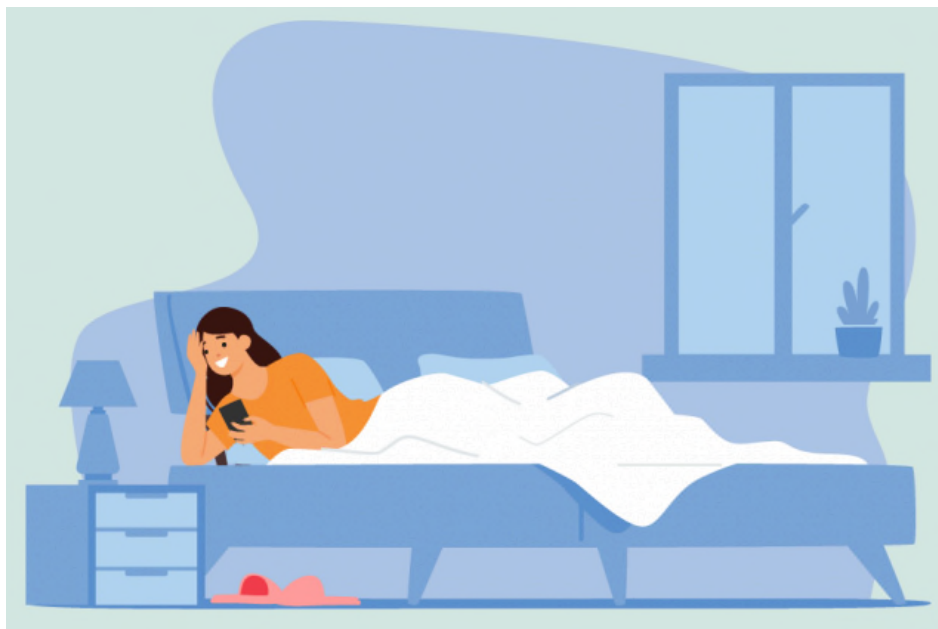
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Wearing Masks or Respirators

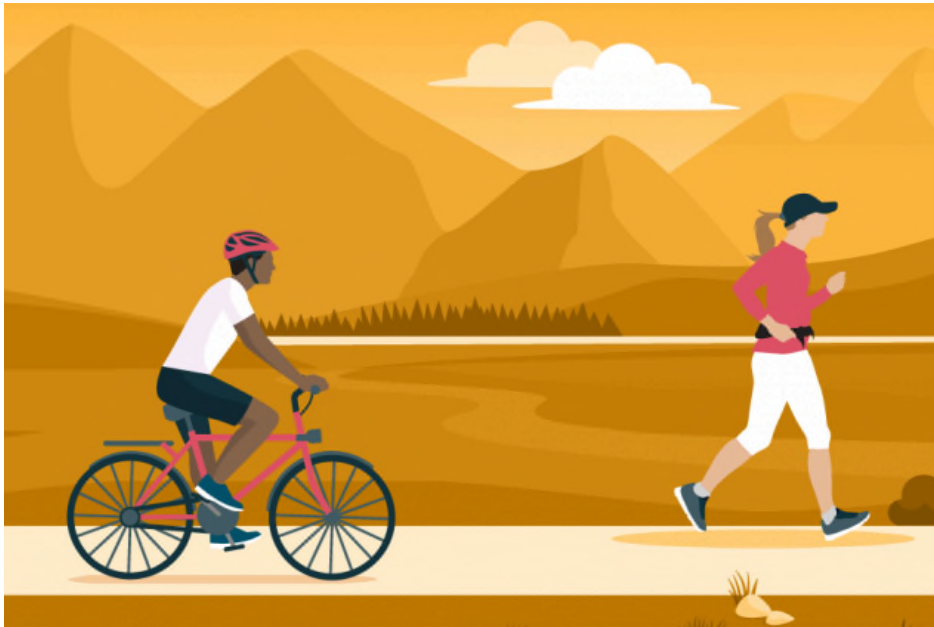


Masks are made to contain droplets and particles that you breathe, cough, or sneeze out. A variety of masks are available. Some masks provide a higher level of protection than others.

Respirators (for example, N95) are made to protect you by fitting closely on the face to filter out particles, including the virus that causes COVID-19. They can also block droplets and particles you breathe, cough, or sneeze out so you do not spread them to others. Respirators (for example, N95) provide higher protection than masks.

When wearing a mask or respirator (for example, N95), it is most important to choose one that you can wear correctly, that fits closely to your face over your mouth and nose, that provides good protection, and that is comfortable for you.

Increasing Space and Distance



Small particles that people breathe out can contain virus particles. The closer you are to a greater number of people, the more likely you are to be exposed to the virus that causes COVID-19. To avoid this possible exposure, you may want to avoid crowded areas, or keep distance between yourself and others. These actions also protect people who are at [high risk for getting very sick from COVID-19](#) in settings where there are [multiple risks for exposure](#).

Additional Resources

[COVID-19 Community Levels](#)

[Science Brief: SARS-CoV-2 Transmission](#)

[Science Brief: Indicators for Monitoring COVID-19 Community Levels and Making Public Health Recommendations](#)

[Science Brief: Community Use of Masks to Control the Spread of SARS-CoV-2](#)

[Science Brief: COVID-19 Vaccines and Vaccination](#)

Last Updated Jan. 26, 2023



How to Protect Yourself and Others

Updated July 6, 2023

COVID-19 Prevention Actions

There are many ways your actions can help protect you, your household, and your community from severe illness from COVID-19. [CDC's COVID-19 hospital admission levels](#) provide information about the amount of severe illness in the community where you are located to help you decide when to take action to protect yourself and others.

Prevention Actions to Use at All COVID-19 Community Levels

In addition to basic health and hygiene practices, like [handwashing](#), CDC recommends some prevention actions at all COVID-19 hospital admission levels, which include:

- [Staying Up to Date with COVID-19 Vaccines](#)
- [Improving Ventilation](#)
- [Getting Tested for COVID-19 If Needed](#)
- [Following Recommendations for What to Do If You Have Been Exposed](#)
- [Staying Home If You Have Suspected or Confirmed COVID-19](#)
- [Seeking Treatment If You Have COVID-19 and Are at High Risk of Getting Very Sick](#)
- [Avoiding Contact with People Who Have Suspected or Confirmed COVID-19](#)

 **Download:** [Build Your Personal COVID-19 Plan – English \[561 KB, 3 pages\]](#) | [Other Languages](#)

Staying Up to Date with COVID-19 Vaccines



COVID-19 vaccines help your body develop protection from the virus that causes COVID-19. Although vaccinated people sometimes get infected with the virus that causes COVID-19, [staying up to date](#) on COVID-19 vaccines significantly lowers the risk of getting very sick, being hospitalized, or dying from COVID-19. CDC recommends that everyone [stay up to date on their COVID-19 vaccines](#), especially [people with weakened immune systems](#).

To find COVID-19 vaccine locations near you: Search [vaccines.gov](https://www.vaccines.gov), text your ZIP code to 438829, or call 1-800-232-0233.

Improving Ventilation and Spending Time Outdoors



[Improving ventilation](#) (moving air into, out of, or within a room) and filtration (trapping particles on a filter to remove them from the air) can help prevent virus particles from accumulating in indoor air. Improving ventilation and filtration can help protect you from getting infected with and spreading the virus that causes COVID-19. Spending time outside when possible instead of inside can also help: Viral particles spread between people more readily [indoors than outdoors](#).

Actions that can [improve ventilation and filtration](#) include:

- Bringing in as much outdoor air as possible—for example, opening windows.
- Increasing air filtration in your heating, ventilation, and air conditioning (HVAC) system, such as by changing filters frequently and using filters that are properly fitted and provide higher filtration.
- Using portable high-efficiency particulate air (HEPA) cleaners.
- Turning on exhaust fans and using other fans to improve air flow.
- Turning your thermostat to the “ON” position instead of “AUTO” to ensure your HVAC system provides [continuous airflow and filtration](#).

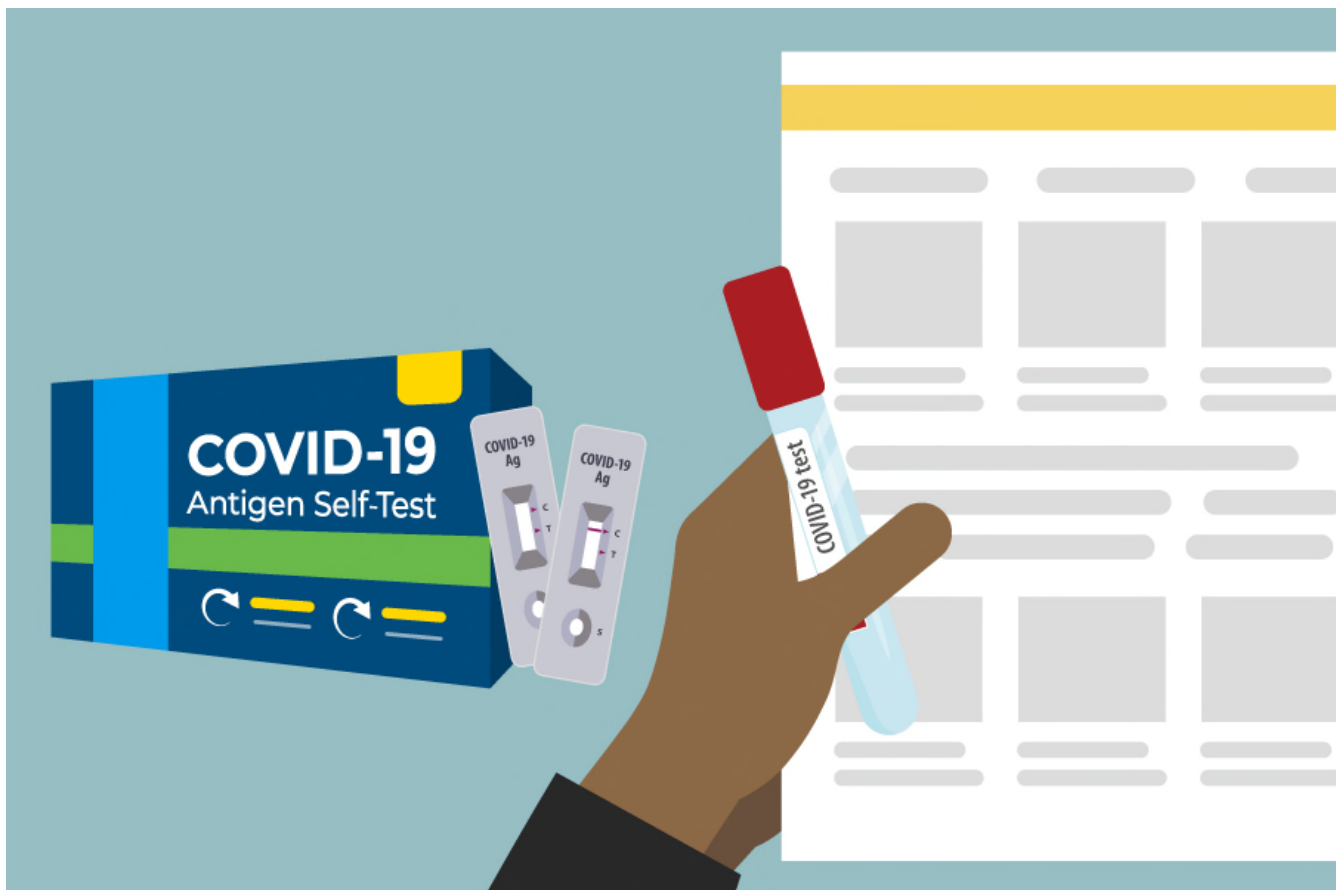
CDC’s interactive ventilation tools can help you see how much you can improve ventilation in your [home](#) or [school](#).

Moving indoor activities outdoors

You are less likely to be infected with COVID-19 during outdoor activities because virus particles do not build up in the air outdoors as much as they do indoors. As the COVID-19 hospital admission level rises, consider increasing the number of group activities you move outside.

[Financial support](#)  may be available to certain entities, like schools, to make ventilation improvements.

Getting Tested for COVID-19



[Get tested](#) if you have [COVID-19 symptoms](#). A viral test tells you if you are infected with the virus that causes COVID-19. If you have COVID-19 symptoms, you should get tested for COVID-19 immediately. If you have been exposed to COVID-19 and do not have symptoms, you should test 5 full days after your exposure. If you do not test at the right time, you are more likely to get an inaccurate test result.

You may choose to get a PCR test at a testing site or healthcare facility. PCR tests are more likely to detect the virus compared to antigen tests. Rapid antigen tests provide results quickly and are available at testing sites or for use at-home. [FDA recommends](#)  2 negative antigen tests (if you have symptoms) or 3 negative antigen tests (if you do not have symptoms), performed 2 days (48 hours) apart to be confident that you do not have COVID-19.

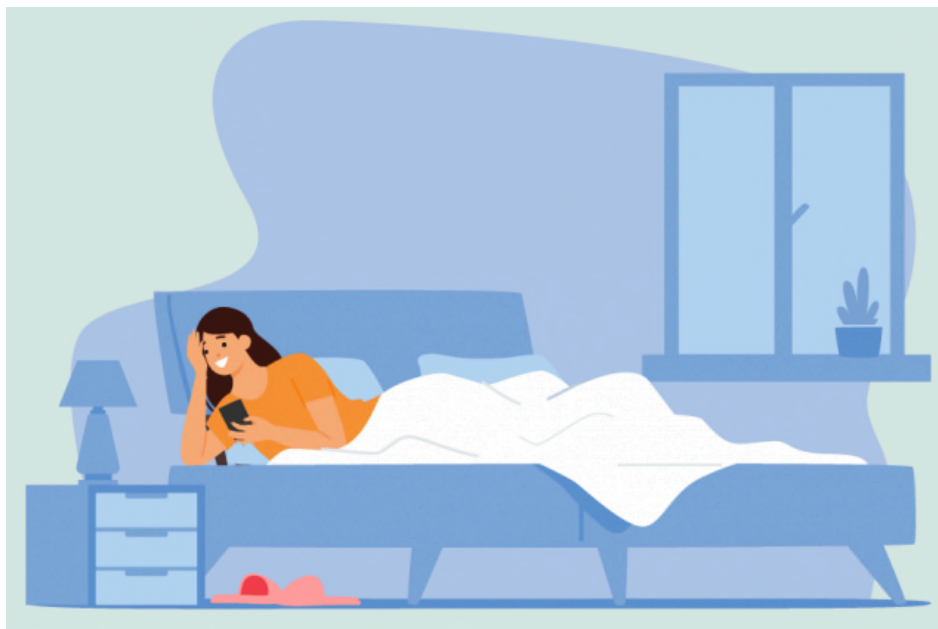
Even when you don't have symptoms or a recent exposure to COVID-19, testing may help you make informed decisions about your health and your risk of spreading COVID-19 to others, especially those who are at [higher risk of severe illness](#).

Following Recommendations for What to Do If You Have Been Exposed



If you were exposed to someone with COVID-19, you may have been infected with the virus. Follow CDC's recommendations for [what to do if you were exposed](#). This includes wearing a high-quality mask when indoors around others (including inside your home) for 10 days, testing, and monitoring yourself for symptoms.

Staying Home When You Have Suspected or Confirmed COVID-19



If you have COVID-19, you can spread it to others, even if you do not have symptoms. If you have symptoms, get tested and stay home until you have your results. If you have tested positive (even without symptoms), follow CDC's [isolation recommendations](#). These recommendations include staying home and away from others for at least 5 days (possibly more, depending on how the virus affects you) and wearing a high-quality mask when indoors around others for a period of time.

Seeking Treatment If You Have COVID-19 and Are at High Risk of Getting Very Sick



Effective treatments are now widely available and free, and you may be eligible.

- Contact your healthcare provider, [health department](#), or [Community Health Center](#)  to learn about [treatment options](#).
- Don't delay! Treatment must be started within a few days after you first develop symptoms to be effective.
- If you don't have timely access to a healthcare provider, check if a [Test to Treat location](#)  is in your community. You can get tested, receive a prescription from a healthcare provider (either onsite or by telehealth), and have it filled all at one location.

Avoiding Contact with People Who Have Suspected or Confirmed COVID-19



Avoiding contact with people who have COVID-19, whether or not they feel sick, can reduce your risk of catching the virus from them. If possible, avoid being around a person who has COVID-19 until they can [safely end home isolation](#). Sometimes it may not be practical for you to stay away from a person who has COVID-19 or you may want to help take care of them. In those situations, use as many prevention strategies as you can, such as practicing hand hygiene, consistently and correctly wearing a high-quality mask, improving ventilation, and keeping your distance, when possible, from the person who is sick or who tested positive.

Prevention Actions to Add as Needed

There are some additional prevention actions that may be done at any level, but CDC especially recommends considering in certain circumstances or at medium or high [COVID-19 hospital admission levels](#).

- [Wearing Masks or Respirators](#)
- [Increasing Space and Distance](#)

Wearing Masks or Respirators

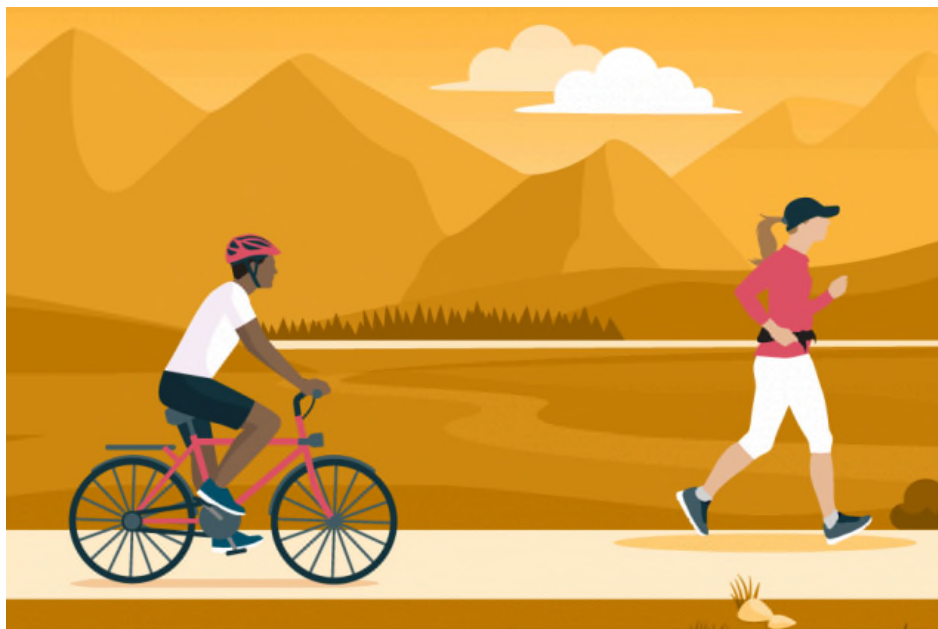


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Related Pages

- › [Facility Cleaning & Ventilation](#)
- › [Schools & Child Care](#)
- › [Homeless Service Sites & Correctional Facilities](#)
- › [Congregate Living Settings](#)
- › [Tribal Communities](#)

Additional Resources

[COVID-19 Hospital Admission Levels](#)

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Science Brief: COVID-19 Vaccines and Vaccination

Archived Content

Search for and find historical COVID-19 pages and files. Please note the content on these pages and files is no longer being updated and may be out of date.

- Visit archive.cdc.gov for a historical snapshot of the COVID-19 website, capturing the end of the Federal Public Health Emergency on June 28, 2023.
- Visit the [dynamic COVID-19 collection](#) to search the COVID-19 website as far back as July 30, 2021.

Last Updated July 6, 2023